



SKOAR!

SMITE

Smitten!

Thank ye gods!

Prakrit 'The Pony' Dhondiyal

As children, the idea of all-powerful gods was always appealing. One could indulge in hours-long arguments about whether Zeus wipe out the sleepy Kumbhakarna. Can Mercury run circles around the mighty Ra? Who would survive the slugfest of Death – Hades, Thanatos or Osiris? Above all – can Gods from seven different mythologies work together to kick ass? SMITE allows people to put their foot where their mouth is.

At the risk of sounding hipster, we got into SMITE before it became mainstream. Somehow though, after that initial excitement, we got off the innovative MOBA in favour of some other games vying for our attention towards the end of 2012. Why

did it fail to keep us hooked? Was it something inherent? Well the game's come a long way since its beta days. (If you're curious about our 2012 beta review, you can find it in the Empower DVD).

Back in beta, some gods did seem to be over-powered. Ares, for example, had an ultimate that chained everyone and bunched them together, leaving them sitting ducks for anyone with an AoE (Area of Effect) attack to pounce and end it. Ahh the golden age of penta kills in SMITE. But as with all MOBAs, patches try and fix imbalance and eventually excessively powerful gods were nerfed, weak gods have been given their dues and there is a counter for every attack in the game – if you

MOAR

PRICE: FREE

GENRE: MOBA (Massive Online Battle Arena)

DEVELOPERS: Hi-Rez Studios

PUBLISHERS: Hi-Rez Studios

PLATFORM: Microsoft Windows

have the knowledge and experience to make use of it. The game finally started to take shape.

But why would one play SMITE over the other MOBAs? League of Legends has been around for quite a while and DOTA 2 is so popular already. Even Awesomenauts brings in the challenge of playing MOBA in two dimensions. SMITE's USP is the perspective. The third-person perspective puts the player right in the midst of the action. Unlike most other MOBAs, SMITE pulls away from the isometric view of the battle ground, changing the combat experience. The game's perspective makes the gameplay more immersive.

Smite doesn't have a steep learning curve, which is a huge advantage for newer players. The controls are a combination of the keyboard and mouse for both movement and attacks. This makes all the difference to the gamer. SMITE pulls you headlong into the action of the game. You still have three lanes, five opponents and four teammates. But one can get more into the game when fighting the opponent up close. Imagine the perfect mash-up of World of Warcraft and Dota 2 – and you have SMITE.

Despite being a freemium game, Smite doesn't let you pay to win, which is a good thing. Pings to European servers are generally in the 200-350ms range, which is playable at best. Despite a few minor flaws here and there, this is a great game with a thriving community.

It's high time you jumped on this bandwagon, if you haven't already, go

to <http://dgit.in/webreff> or

<http://dgit.in/statreff> to sign up.

Smite is so much more than this tiny little review. Head over to www.thinkdigit.com for the full story. *

